

INTER STUDY STUFF

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Q/Ans Theory

XI - ENGLISH

ENGLISH NEW BOOK CLASS XI (STBB)

SECTION-C PLAY

“A VISIT TO A SMALL PLANET”

NOTES OF ALL EXERCISES OF
THE ABOVE PLAY

BY SIR AMEER ALI

VIBRANT TIME ACADEMY
SIR AMEER ALI 0308-2908884

SECTION-C: PLAY.

A VISIT TO SMALL PLANET.

Exercise 1.

Work in pairs and scan the text to write the synonym of the following words contextually. Use them in sentences. After completing, share your work with your partner.

No	Word.	Contextual Meanings.	Sentence
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1. impromptu.

Meaning. (unprepared.)

Sentence.

He made an impromptu speech about honor and responsibility.

2. lunatic.

Meaning. (a person who is mentally ill.)

Sentence.

He drives like a lunatic.

3. blazing.

Meaning. (Very hot.)

Sentence.

Quite a few people were eating outside in the blazing sun.

4. giddy.

Meaning. (feeling silly, happy, and excited and showing this in your behaviour.)

Sentence.

She was giddy with excitement.

5. reconnoitring.

Meaning: (Surveying, to obtain information about its geographical features or about the size and position of an army there.)

Sentence:

He was sent to Eritrea to reconnoitre the enemy position.

6. disposition.

Meaning: (The particular type of character that a person naturally has.)

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Sentence:

She is of a nervous disposition.

7. primitive.

Meaning (of, belonging to, or seeming to come from an early time in the very ancient past.)

Sentence.

The time when primitive man first learned to use fire.

8. seethe.

Meaning. (to feel very angry but to be unable or unwilling to express it clearly.)

Sentence.

The rest of the class positively seethed with indignation when Julia won the award.

9. unctuous.

Meaning. (excessively flattering or ingratiating; oily.)

Sentence.

He seemed anxious to please but not in an unctuous way.

10. fidgets.

Meaning. (uneasiness or restlessness as shown by nervous movements.)

Sentence.

There were two new arrivals, fidgeting around, waiting to ask questions.

11. sordid.

Meaning. (dirty and unpleasant.)

Sentence.

There are lots of really sordid apartments in the city's poorer areas.

12. resonant.

Meaning. (continuing to sound.)

Sentence.

His words were resonant with meaning.

Exercise 2

Read the statements and encircle the correct option.

1. The play takes place in a small suburb in _____.
 - a. Maryland
 - b. Washington
 - c. Virginia
 - d. Indiana
2. Spelding _____ flying object in space.
 - a. accepts
 - b. denies
 - c. doubts
 - d. confirms
3. Spelding criticizes John for growing _____.
 - a. cabbage
 - b. walnuts
 - c. corn
 - d. peanuts✓
4. Kreton appears to be in his
 - a. twenties
 - b. thirties
 - c. forties
 - d. fifties
5. The impression of Kreton on seeing the inside of the house was _____.
 - a. disgusted
 - b. delighted
 - c. callous
 - d. sorrowful
6. The spaceship landed in Mrs. Spelding's _____.
 - a. rose garden
 - b. petunia bed
 - c. greenhouse
 - d. vegetable garden
7. Kreton said that the earthmen were his _____.
 - a. hobby

- b. ruination
- c. hope
- d. models

8. Kreton mistakenly thought that he had come to earth in the _____.

- a. 18th century
- b. 19th century
- c. 20th century
- d. 21st century

9. The first person who arrived to investigate the spaceship was _____.

- a. Powers
- b. Laurent
- c. President of the United States
- d. neighbour

10. Kreton said people on his planet did not _____.

- a. did not fight
- b. did not speak
- c. did not die
- d. did not love

11. Kreton's space ship was of _____ shape.

- a. elliptical
- b. oval
- c. circular
- d. triangular

12. John could not use the telephone because _____.

- a. Kreton had cut communication
- b. Spelding did not have any
- c. Powers declared martial law
- d. Spelding wouldn't give him permission

13. General Powers was thinking about _____.

- a. his promotion
- b. security of the country
- c. arrest of Kreton
- d. murder of the visitor

14. According to Kreton, civilization is just _____.

- a. at the ending
- b. at the beginning
- c. full bloom
- d. creeping

15. The elements of science fiction in this passage are most pronounced in _____.

- a. Kreton's supernatural abilities
- b. reactions to Kreton
- c. Kreton belongs to another breed of human
- d. hobbies of Kreton

16. Kreton placed an invisible wall around his spaceship because _____.

- a. the army told him to.
- b. the army was going to take it apart.
- c. the earth's atmosphere was damaging it.
- d. his own people had suggested it.

17. Powers accused Kreton of coming to earth _____.

- a. 100 years too soon
- b. to spread a mysterious disease
- c. to discover some natural resources
- d. to reconnoitre before an invasion

18. Kreton said John's thoughts about Ellen were _____.

- a. black
- b. red
- c. purple
- d. yellow

19. Kreton considers human civilization _____.

- a. modern
- b. primitive
- c. conservative
- d. rational

20. Kreton intends to take charge of _____.

- a. rose garden
- b. Spelding's house

- c. USA
- d. [world](#)

Exercise 3

Work in pairs. Skim through the text. First, write the name of respective character who said the following dialogues in Column B, and write the context of the dialogues in which character had said that particular dialogue in Column C. First one has been done as an example. After completing, share your work with your partner.

Column A (Dialogue)

1. Fair enough. All right, I'll stay on for a while.

Column B (character)

([Kreton](#))

Column C In the Context of

This statement or dialogue is said to Spelding when Spelding instructed him to stay because of General Power's interview.

2. He has no get-up-and-go. ([Spelding](#))

This statement or dialogue is said to Ellen. Her father Spelding criticizes her Fiance John who is lazy.

3. I am a hobbyist. I love to gad about.

([Kreton](#))

This dialogue is said to Powers by Kreton in order to inform him his reason of visiting the Earth.

4. But I prefer the ones made of metal, the ones you used to wear, you know: with the feathers on top.

([Kreton](#))

This dialogue is said to Powers by Kreton. Kreton tells him about the costumes he want to wear.

5. Poor fragile butterflies, such brief little moments in the sun...

([Kreton](#))

The dialogue is said to Powers when he asks Kreton about the place from where he comes.

6. I like his whiskers. They're so very... comforting.
(Mrs. Spelding)

This statement is said to Spelding when they were discussing about the alien and its physical appearance.

Exercise 4

Work individually and make a list of the elements of science fiction you find in the play. After you have done, compare your list with your class fellows.

1. Setting.

Setting of the play is America, which is perfect for science fiction.

2. Plot.

The plot of the play revolves around the Kreton (an alien) and his spaceship (a technological machine).

3. Characters.

(Kreton, Spaceship)

4. Examples

1. Kreton uses his scientific powers to land on the Earth.

2. He uses his technological powers to make an invisible wall around the saucer.

3. His scientific powers to stun the people.

4. The play also start with the broadcasting telling about the science and it's importance.

Exercise 5

Work in pairs and arrange the scrambled events in the order of their occurrence in the play by giving the number. After you have completed, share your work with your partner.

No	Events	Order
1.	Kreton arrives on the earth.	<u>(03)</u>

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2. General Powers comes with his Aide. [\(04\)](#)
3. Kreton reads the mind of General Powers. [\(07\)](#)
4. General Powers orders to grab Kreton. [\(10\)](#)
5. John spots a spaceship. [\(02\)](#)
6. Kreton announces to take over the world. [\(09\)](#)
7. Spelding makes a broadcast and denies any spaceship landing on earth. [\(01\)](#)
8. Aide stops Spelding from making a call. [\(05\)](#)
9. Kreton reads the minds of John and Ellen. [\(08\)](#)
10. General Powers and Kreton have a conversation in the study. [\(06\)](#)

Exercise 6

Read the text and answer the following questions.

1. What is ironic about Spelding's broadcast at the beginning of the play?

Ans. Ironic about Spelding's broadcasting at the beginning of the play is that his own daughter has heard the broadcast but she has not understood even a single word of his father's broadcast. Example of the sentence said by Spelding reveals the clear use of irony. "It is not very flattering when one's own daughter won't listen to what one says while millions of people....."

2. Why is Spelding unhappy about the relationship between Ellen and John?

Ans. Roger Spelding is unhappy about the relationship between Ellen and John because he does not like his daughter's fiancé. John Randolph is not a hard worker ambitious. He is not an adventurer. Spelding does not like a person having no ambition. He is an adventurous man. He expects his son in law as an adventurous too...

3. Why did Kreton want to visit earth?

Answer: Kreton visited the earth to see the civil war in 19th century. Mistakenly he came one century later. To visit the Earth and her inhabitants

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was his hobby. Therefore, he took a lot of interest in Earth. He visited the Earth as a tourist, then he decided to take the charge of the world.

4. How is Kreton able to communicate with the people on earth?

Ans. Kreton is able to communicate with the people on Earth because he has power to read the minds of people. He reads the language inside the minds of people.

5. Describe the reaction of different characters to Kreton's visit?

Ans.

1. **Roger Spelding** believes it as a meteor.

2. **Mrs. Spelding** likes its personality but does not like its way of landing on her Rose Garden. He worries about her beautiful garden.

3. **Ellen** is fearful and excited to know about Kreton and his spaceship. She enjoys to be with the alien.

4. **John** also wants to be with the new strange thing. He wants to examine Kreton and its spaceship just for having fun. He is really excited to know more and more about the alien.

5. **General Powers** expects Kreton as a spy or a hostile enemy of men. He takes him as an invader.

6. **Aide** becomes confused and excited after looking the strange creature.

6. Why is General Powers paranoid about Kreton's visit?

Ans. General powers was paranoid about kreton's visit because he suspected kreton as an spy of outer planet who came here on the Earth to explore the secrets in order to invade and destroy the planet. He further suspected him to leak the secrets to another aliens to plan the destruction of the Earth.

7. What restrictions are imposed on Spelding's family?

Ans. The Spelding's house is kept under Martial Law. No one can leave the house. They are also forbidden to use the phone. For their movement they need to the permission of Powers.

8. What extraordinary powers does Kreton possess, and how does he exhibit these powers?

Ans: Kreton is a wonderful creature. He proves his extraordinary powers in various ways. He has the following powers he shows on many occasions.

* He has power to take over the charge of the world. He tells it many times to Powers.

- * He has power to read the minds of the people. He reads the minds of almost all the characters.
- * He has power to create a shield around him and his spaceship. When his ship is ordered to be moved he makes a circle line round the spaceship and it can't be moved by anyone.
- * He has power to know all the languages of the world. Because he can read the mind of every person.

9. Why does Spelding want Kreton to stay?

Ans. Spelding wants Kreton to stay with him in his house because he shows hospitality to him. He thinks the visitor is tired after a long travel. Secondly, he also intends to interview this strange creature in his television broadcast.

10. Why did Kreton's friends consider him pervasive?

Ans: Kreton's friend considered him pervasive (perverse) because he was interested in earth primitive society. But it was his taste that he loved the people and he wanted to be native.

11. How does Kreton reveal that he does not have any favourable view of earthlings?

Ans. At the end of the play Kreton reveals that the people of his planet are not interested in visiting earth, but he is interested because he wants to take charge of earth and rule all of you.

12. How does Kreton foil General Power's attempts to confine him?

Ans. Kreton with his technological powers foils General Power's to arrest him. He makes General Power and Aide stun and challenges them to arrest him.

13. Who is Aide? What is his role in the play?

Ans. Aide is the captain in the army. He works under the custody of General Powers. He plays a minor role in the story. His role is just to follow the instructions of General Powers who instructs him to investigate the spaceship, arrest the Kreton, maintain the Martial Law, etc.

14. How did Aide describe Kreton's spaceship?

Answer: He described that Kreton's Spaceship was elliptical, with a fourteen feet diameter. And It was made of an unknown metal which shined and inside there was not anything.

15. Describe the main comic incidents of the play?

Ans. There are many comic scenes in the play 'A Visit to a Small Planet'. Actually, the play is comic in nature. Kreton and his Spaceship, are also comic creatures. The most comic incidents are the landing of Kreton. How he lands, how he looks like, his costumes, his whiskers and his way of talking are all comic in nature. Another comic incident is General Powers' visit to Spelding's house and his meeting with Kreton. He starts the dialogue by calling Kreton as a joker. The story ends with a comic scene. Kreton's way of making stunned to the all worldly characters. After then, his yawning and noticing Mrs. Spelding's Rose Garden is also comic ending of the play.

16. How is media depicted in the play?

Ans. In the play, freedom of media is criticized. It is depicted as an unfair. The higher authority can control and use it as they want... The play starts with the broadcasting of Roger Spelding. In his whole broadcasting, he says those things which are instructed to him by General Powers. He does not feel freedom to say what he wants to say. As his wife says that they always like his broadcasting. He also uses the word Starve. It means if he does not follow the instructions during broadcasting, they will die of hunger.

17. The play is a satire on American society. Discuss.

Ans. "A Visit to a Small Planet" can certainly be read and enjoyed as a satirical play. Satire creates its effects by mocking human behaviors and assumptions in an effort to raise a reader or viewer's awareness of what the satirist sees as their foolishness. In the play the American society is targeted. The family system is not following any particular rules. Each three members of Spelding's family have different ideas opposite to each other. No one is ready to follow another. Only outward behaviours are respected. The media is also satirized. The media works not freely, but it just works to follow the instructions of the persons who are in power. Army in particular and bureaucracy in general is targeted. The officer behaviour towards the inferior is not good. The Americans are also not ready to accept the importance of newness. In his satirical play, Gore Vidal tries to reveal a fresh life, full of technology, the American needs.

18. How does the playwright expose the inferiority of the present race to that of the future?

Ans. Kreton represents the future race. He exposes the weakness of the present race by calling it in its primitive stage. The residents of present age have not yet made the mind to change themselves as per need of the time. The coming race would be more powerful and aware how to control mind and

emotions. As the people of the current age are impatient, stubborn and having no power to control their own ideas. They are lag behind in development from the upcoming advanced age.

19. Describe the arrival of the flying saucer in your own words.

Ans. The flying saucer slowly alights at the Rose Garden in the house of Mr. and Mrs. Spelding. The house is in Maryland, USA. It lands slowly and strangely. The pilot (Kreton) comes out patiently. He is in strange costumes.

20. How much advanced is the civilization of Kreton than of the Earth?

Ans. The civilization of Kreton is much more advanced than of the Earth. They have power to control their thoughts and emotions. They can use flying cars to travel. They are immortal. On the other hand, the Earth people are at the beginning of their civilization. They are mortal and do not have any control over their emotions and thoughts.

21. Why can the people of earth not compete with people of Kreton?

Ans. The people of Earth cannot compete with those of Kreton. They have not yet achieve the tricks and powers to handle the situation masterly because they are in their initial stage. They have to learn more and more for perfection. While the people of Kreton are well trained and much more advanced as compare to the Earth. They know the proper use of their minds. They know how to control and handle the people of other civilization.

22. What type of life do you foresee in the year 5000?

Ans. I foresee a wonderful life in the year 5000. The People will be perfect. Because of technological developments they will be able to travel in flying cars. They will have enough power to read and hear the human mind. They will make themselves immortal.

23. What are the literary elements used in "Visit to a Small Planet," and how they enhance the story?

Ans. The following literary devices are used in the play

Satire

"Satire" is any work of art that uses ridicule, humor, and wit in order to criticize and provoke change in human nature or social institutions. The play examines (and pokes fun at) contemporary ideas about war, the fear of "foreign" invasion, and attitudes towards inferior sex. Vidal satires military, bureaucracy and social media. Family system is also satirized.

Black Humor

"Black humor" refers to comedy created by means not usually regarded as proper subjects for laughter. For example, although *Visit to a Small Planet* is a comedy. The plot concerns an impending nuclear war and the destruction of the entire world for one person's amusement.

Irony

The play starts the ironical broadcasting. The ironical views of Spelding about the existence of spaceship. The irony of his daughter and mother when they confirm their attention towards the broadcasting they don't understand any single word. The play itself is an irony because the aliens are not yet confirmed as the creation.

24. Who is your favourite character in this play and why?

Ans. Ellen, the daughter of Mr. Spelding is my favourite character. She is energetic, caring and true lover. She becomes excited when she sees Kreton. She calls many times to John (her fiance) as he can not be harmed by the strange creature. She cares a lot for her future husband because she loves him by heart. She teaches lesson that everybody should be caring and loving.

Exercise 7

Suppose an alien visits the Earth from another planet. Work in pairs and prepare a list of your questions that you would ask the alien. Next, prepare the alien's answers. After you have completed, share your work with your class fellows.

Ans. If an alien visits the Earth I will ask the following questions from him/her.

0. Who are you?

Alien. I am an alien.

1. What do people call you?

Alien. People call me Kreton.

2. Where are you from?

Aline. I am from another planet.

3. What is the life on your planet?

Alien. It is very simple life on our planet. People live cooperatively and never to harm another.

4. Why do you look like a joker?

Alien. It is because of my costumes. We wear such type of costumes different from yours so that I seem to you a joker.

5. Are all others on your planet wear such type of odd dress?

Alien. Yes. We all wear this type of dress. This is our traditional dress.

6. Why have you come here on our planet?

Alien. I like the greenery of your planet. I love it. So that I visited to your planet.

7. Are not you an spy?

Alien. No. On our planet, people never think or plan to harm others. So that I am not an spy. I just came here for enjoying the beauty of the planet.

8. Which thing do you like more on Our earth?

Alien. Your hospitality. I like the way you speak, behave and serve. It is really amazing.

9. What is famous on your planet?

Alien. 'Lambha Dancing' is famous on our planet. It is a type of dancing we use to do collectively on the beat of saucers.

10. Do you usually visit to our planet?

Alien. No. I was interested. But this is my first time to visit your planet.

Exercise 8

Work individually and sketch the following characters with the help of below given mind map. Once you have completed, share your work with your class fellows.

Characters.

a. Mr. Spelding

Mr. Spelding is a major character in the play. He has the following qualities.

Personality Traits

He is a middle-aged, unctuous and resonant.

Role

He plays a role of TV Broadcaster in the play. He is a major character in the plays. He plays a vital role in the developing of story.

Actions

1. His broadcasting about the Spaceship. He denies the new technology.
2. His protest against the marriage relationship of his daughter Ellen and John.
3. His protest against the Martial Law at his house.

Others Opinion

Professionally, he is sincere and honest. He cares for his family a lot. He is an adventurous and ambitious. He is proud of American. He is an American in nature. Over all he is a sincere person.

b. Mrs. Spelding

Personality Traits

She is bored and vague. She knits passively while his husband talks at his desk.

Role

She plays the role of a wife of A TV Broadcaster and the owner of the Rose Garden where Kreton is landed with his spaceship.

Actions

She interrupts and favours her daughter against her husband. She also favours John while her husband is talking about him. She protests against the Kreton who spoils her Rose Garden.

Others Opinion.

She is fashionable lady. She cares her fashion a lot. When she sees Kreton she likes his whiskers a lot. For that she goes to her make up room and use it to beautify herself. She has no sacrificial sense. She always worries about her Rose Garden. Except, she has a sympathetic nature. She sympathizes with John and her daughter.

c. Ellen

Personality Traits

She is lively, energetic and beautiful girl of twenty. She fidgets as she listens.

Role

She plays as a role of a daughter of the TV Broadcaster whose house is used for the setting of the play.

Actions

She goes against her father in the matter of her marriage with John. She favours John and his work.

She interferes and requests Kreton to read her and John's minds.

Other Opinions.

She is a lover and always favours John, his fiancée. She is caring because she cares John a lot while he goes near to Kreton and his spaceship. She is sensitive and fanciful too. Over all, she is nice of nature.

d. John**Personality Traits**

Young and energetic boy.

Role

He plays the role of a fiancée and the first person who notifies the appearance of Kreton and its spaceship.

Actions

Comes and witnesses first the appearance of Kreton and his spaceship. First person goes very close to the alien. Worries about the family who don't know where he is.

Others Opinion

He is hard worker but not ambitious. He has his own farmhouse. He sits and works there but never tries to do an adventurous work. He has purple thoughts about Ellen.

e. General Powers**Personality Traits**

Middle-aged General, greedy of promotion and proud of America. He is disciplined and sober person.

Role

He plays a major role. In some sense he can be said a villain of the play. He plays an antagonist role against Kreton.

Actions

He comes with his equipped army to arrest the Kreton. He imposes Martial Law in the house of Spelding. He warns Kreton to surrender. He also talks to the president of the United States.

Others Opinion

He is an honest army officer. He works first for his country then for his promotion. He is boast of America. He represents a true American. Over all, he is disciplined and sober officer.

f. Kreton

Personality Traits

He is forty years old. He is a mild, pleasant looking man with side whiskers and dressed in the fashion of 1860.

Role

He plays major role in the play. He is the hero of the play. The play surrounds his role.

Actions

He reads the minds of the earthen people. He encounters with General Powers. He stuns the army of General Powers.

Others Opinion

He is kind and soft nature person. He speaks kindly to every one. He has full control over his mind and emotions. He never hurries to do the things. He does the things on the exact time.

Exercise 9

Work in pairs and compare and contrast between 'life on earth and on Kreton's planet'. After you have done, share your work with your partner.

Answer: The people of the two planets have no comparison as the people belonging to Kreton's planet are much more advanced than those of the Earth. They can operate cars without any instruments: they can travel huge distances in a day and can speak all languages. The people of the Earth cannot compete with them as they are far more learned and have progressed a lot.

They are free from hatred and are not in the favour of violence. We can determine from the character of Kreton that they feel pride in the service of mankind and are highly sophisticated people. Furthermore, they possess extraordinary powers which are complete myths for humans. They can listen to the minds of other people and we see in the play that Kreton creates an invisible wall around the spaceship. He proclaims that the human civilization is just beginning and upholds the primitive traits. The statement is quite appropriate as we are far backward in comparison to the people of Kreton's planet.

Exercise 10

Work in pairs and summarize the play in your words. After you have summarized, exchange the work with each other.

The Play 'A Visit to a Small Planet' is written by Gore Vidal, an American playwright. It is a reflective comedy. It contains the elements of adventure, suspense, and Comments about the modern civilization. Kreton, a mystery character from other planet, is the central character.

The play starts with the broadcasting of Spelding in his own home in Silver Glen, Maryland (America). Roger Spelding, with his wife, a daughter and two technicians, denies the presence of spaceship. After broadcasting, they start to discuss the household problems. As, Ellen, his daughter, ironically praises the broadcasting of his father. He criticizes John with whom Ellen is going to be married.

Suddenly, the characters face conflicts, while they see an strange creature landing on the Rose Garden of their house. John points out the spaceship first. They have different ideas about it. Some call it a meteor while others deny it. The story goes towards the climax, when Kreton, an alien, comes out from the spaceship. Spelding calls out General Powers, an army man, who confirms to come soon. After a short discussion with Kreton, they notice the arrival of General Powers with his troops.

From here, the climax of the story starts. General Powers imposes Martial Law in the house of Spelding. No one is allowed to move from the house. The general warns Kreton to surrender otherwise, he will be destroyed.

From here the events leads to the ending of the story. Kreton, tells kindly the reason of his coming to the Earth. He confirms that he is neither an spy nor an observer. At last, when General Powers orders Aide to grab him, he shows his super powers. He makes an invisible wall around the spaceship, after it no one can touch it. He also stuns General Powers, Aide and all other Soldiers. At last, he goes to sleep. The play ends here. (Curtain)

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Exercise 11

Work in pairs. Read the play again and identify the elements (i.e. plot, character, dialogue, and setting). After you have identified, write their examples from the text in the table given below.

Plot**Character****Dialogue****Setting****1. Plot.**

The story of the play starts with Spelding's broadcasting. Over all, plot revolves around the Kreton's visit to the Earth. Kreton, an alien, visits here to observe and enjoy this planet. General Powers, represents this planet, encounters the alien. The people of this planet try to resist the alien but fail due to the lack of technological advancement. The play ends with funny scene of stunning the earthly characters by Kreton.

2. Characters.

1. Roger Spelding (TV Broadcaster)
2. Mrs. Spelding (Wife of Roger Spelding)
3. Ellen (Daughter of Roger Spelding)
4. John (Ellen's fiance)
5. General Powers (Army Man)
6. Aide (Captain and work under General Powers)
7. Kreton (Major Character)

Dialogue

Satirical, ironical, serious and some comic dialogues are used in the play.

Setting

The setting of play is pure American. The time mentioned is 19th and 20th century. The play starts and ends in Maryland, America.